

With the power of technology we can create a better future, together

In conversation with Dr. Peter Koerte, Member of the Managing Board, Chief Technology Officer and Chief Strategy Officer, Siemens AG, at Transform – Innovation Day 2024.



Peter, what brings you to India?

It's a great privilege to be here in India a third time. I am here to discuss with our customers about what it takes to bring technology to the next level, how far we've come with bringing digitalization to India and making them successful. Every week, we see new models and new technologies coming our way, and it's very important to keep a good oversight and be a step ahead of these developments.

So, what really goes into taking technology to the next level?

There's one key question that we must start with asking, and that is, 'what if'? 'What if' is a very powerful question because it allows us to look at things from a different angle.

If you take some nice spices and combine them with black tea and a little bit of milk, you get to a warm, delicious cup of chai. This is a great innovation coming out of India. But who would have thought of putting these ingredients together?

We can also do this in technology. What if we combine the technology for lighting, cooling and security in our home with the technology? We create a smart home. We live in a world full of complex challenges. The power of asking "What if" can help us find simple solutions to these challenges. This is especially important in the

industries. Businesses across the board are facing many individual challenges. However, we can sum them up in three main categories: First, businesses have to stay competitive, facing pressure to become more productive. Second, they have to meet increasingly high sustainability targets. And third, they have to become more resilient to keep up with fast-paced developments.

So how can we change this? How can we make it such that we have simple solutions in order to make it work?

At Siemens, we have one simple solution that is at the core of our business: combining the real and the digital worlds. We make the world a smarter place by harnessing the power of data that you're creating every day from your operations. This data comes from buildings, factories or trains. We at Siemens, wholeheartedly believe that we can help all our customers to make this work.

What makes you so convinced about this?

Let me give you an example of how much power data has: A typical factory creates 2,200 terabytes of data every month. This is equivalent to over half a million Netflix movies. This data by itself is useless. But we have a way to make it work for us.

Today, there are an estimated 18 billion IoT devices and

this number is growing at 15% every year. Now just think about what that will do to the amount of data you're going to see in the future. Most of that data in industry is locked, and it's not being used as much as it should be. This is where Siemens Xcelerator comes in. It helps our customers to combine the real world with all the intelligent assets that they have and combine them with intelligence out of the digital world. To do so, you have to look at the full technology stack: from devices in the real world, such as sensors from robots, to industrial edge, to the cloud and the apps that finally use the data from the real world.

Connectivity is the first step. Next comes the conversation about how we get data from the field devices and sensors, which means very often that you process it on an edge level, on site. We can elevate the conversation to the cloud and we can bring you the dedicated applications and the software in order to make all of this work. Combining the real and the digital world is exactly what we do everyday!

Can you share some examples of how you are combining the real and digital worlds?

Sure, let's look at some solutions we have already developed.

Feeding a growing global population has become one of the biggest challenges of our times. The Food